Practical 5: Build the RetailPulse Sales Prompt Report

Related topic: Design a Cognos Prompt Report for Sales Analysis

Name: Akshat Sahu | **Date performed:** 08 October 2026

BCA (DS & AI) | School of Computer Applications, Babu Banarasi Das University | 2026-2027

Objective

Design a prompt page with value, date-range and cascading prompts, and link each control to a report filter.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab from Practical 4.

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Open the **RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab** report from the previous practical.

2. In Page Explorer, choose **Prompt pages > Create prompt page** and move it ahead of the crosstab page.

3. From Toolbox add a **Value prompt** (Region, parameter pRegion) and a **Date & time prompt - range** (parameter pPeriod, Sales Date).

4. Add a second **Value prompt** for Store Name (pStore). Set its **Cascade source** to the Region prompt so its list is limited to the chosen Region.

5. On the crosstab page add detail filters that link each control to its parameter (expressions below).

6. Set **Default selections** (Region = North, period = 01 Jul - 30 Sep 2026, Store = all), add a **Finish** button, then run and test end to end.

Sample Solution (Output)

Filter expressions linking prompts to the crosstab

```
[Region] = ?pRegion?
[Sales Date] between ?pPeriod?
[Store Name] in (?pStore?) (Store prompt: Cascade source = pRegion)
```

Test 1 - Region = North, 01 Jul - 30 Sep 2026

RetailPulse Sales - Prompt Page

Select a region: [North v]

Reporting period: From [2026-07-01] To [2026-09-30]

Select a store: [All stores v] options: All stores, North Plaza, North Square

[Cancel] [Finish]

Region	Electronics		Apparel		Home & Kitchen		Total	
	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity
North	$7,951.63	33	$10,514.63	235	$9,199.05	120	$27,665.31	388
Total	**$7,951.63**	**33**	**$10,514.63**	**235**	**$9,199.05**	**120**	**$27,665.31**	**388**

Test 2 - Region changed to South and resubmitted (Store list updates to South stores)

RetailPulse Sales - Prompt Page

Select a region: [South v]

Reporting period: From [2026-07-01] To [2026-09-30]

Select a store: [All stores v] options: All stores, South Harbor, South Gardens

[Cancel] [Finish]

Region	Electronics		Apparel		Home & Kitchen		Total	
	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity	Sales Amount	Quantity
South	$10,410.86	43	$10,707.01	238	$9,988.91	122	$31,106.78	403
Total	**$10,410.86**	**43**	**$10,707.01**	**238**	**$9,988.91**	**122**	**$31,106.78**	**403**

Figure 5.1: Prompt page and filtered crosstab. North total $27,665.31; South total $31,106.78.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

Submitting the prompt page with Region set to North and a date range within the quarter returns a crosstab filtered to exactly those values; changing Region to South and resubmitting updates both the Store list and the crosstab results correctly.

Expected Outcome

The prompt page renders all three controls; changing Region updates the Store list without error; submitting returns a correctly filtered crosstab; default values produce a sensible report without any changes.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Value, date-range and cascading prompts present	Verified
Store list changes when Region changes	Verified
Each prompt linked to a crosstab filter	Verified
Defaults produce a report; Finish button works	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.